SLAM SPORTS AI

INVESTMENT 01/11

STADIUM CAPITAL

WHO PAYS FOR THE RAYS' $2.3 BILLION BALLPARK

County, city, federal and team money, per the USA Today Network

SWIPE →

THE DEAL

A NEW RAYS BALLPARK IN TAMPA

TAMPA BAY RAYS

NEW BALLPARK AT HILLSBOROUGH COLLEGE'S DALE MABRY CAMPUS

HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY

$2.3B

- 31,000 seats
- 35-year lease
- Opening target: April 2029

OCT 25, 2026

THE PEOPLE

WHO IS BEHIND THE DEAL

PZ

PATRICK ZALUPSKI

Managing partner and co-chair

Tampa Bay Rays

KB

KEN BABBY

Chief executive officer

Tampa Bay Rays

BC

BILL COSGROVE

Co-chair

Tampa Bay Rays

KH

KEN HAGAN

Chair, Board of County Commissioners

Hillsborough County

ND

NEIL DEMAUSE

Stadium-deal reporter

Field of Schemes

THE MONEY

WHO PAYS FOR THE NEW STADIUM

USD

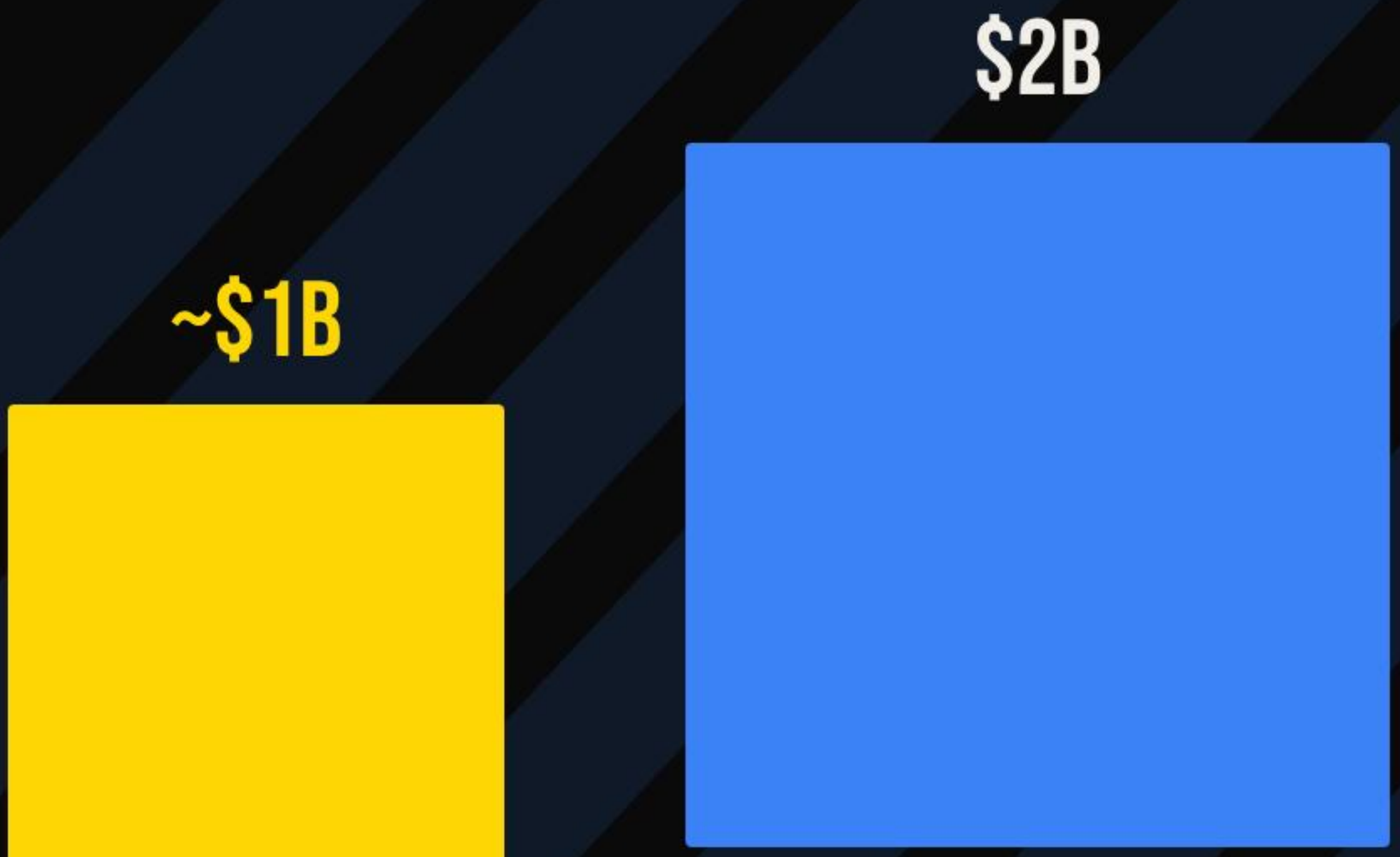


OCT 25, 2026

THE PUBLIC SHARE

ESTIMATES OF THE PUBLIC TAB

USD



Taxpayers, per USA Today Network

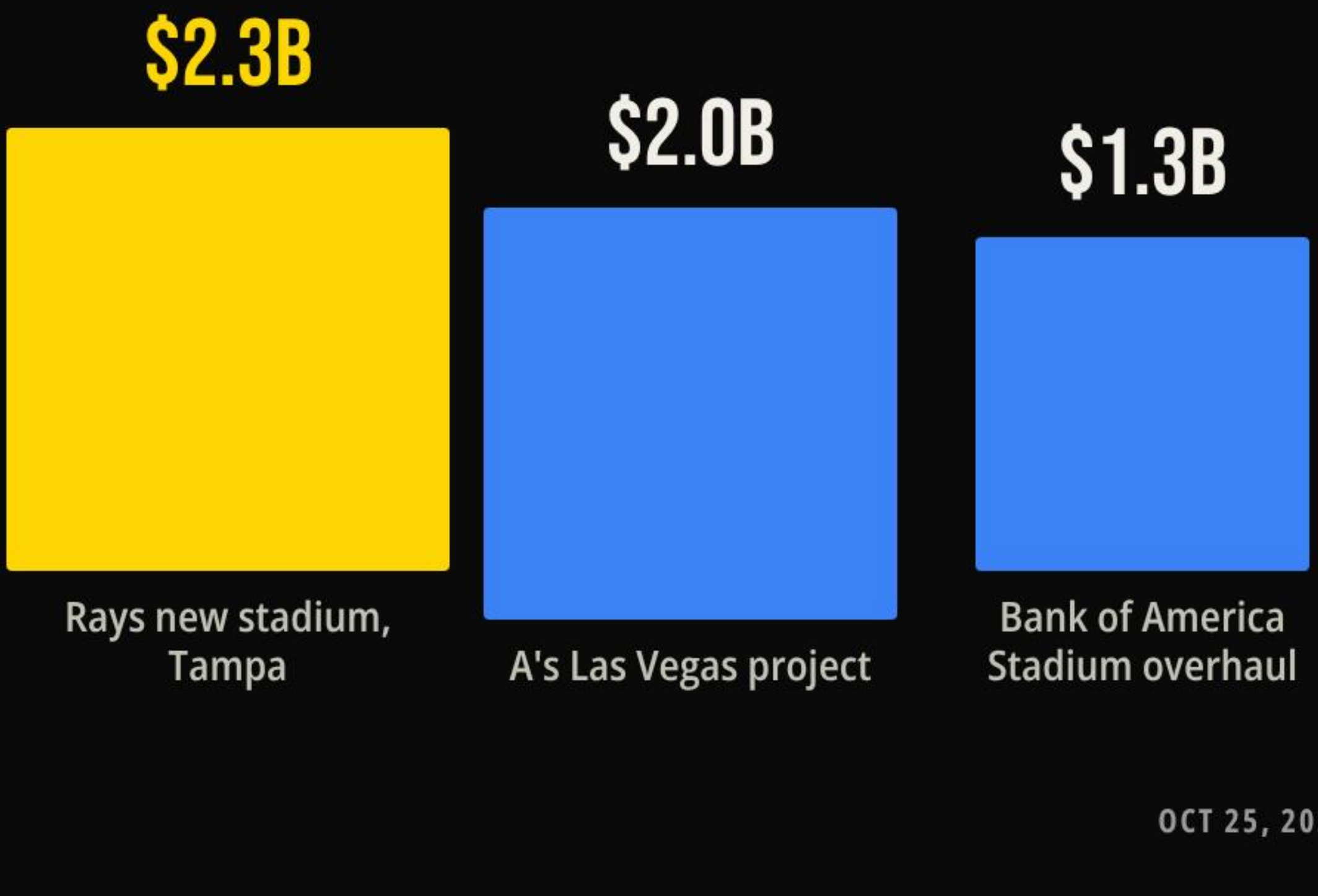
Public, upper bound per Neil deMause

OCT 25, 2026

COMPARABLES

THREE STADIUM PROJECTS, BY COST

USD



OCT 25, 2026

THE OWNERS

WHAT THE ZALUPSKI GROUP PAID

$1.7B

Reported price of the Rays sale

$1.25B
Rays value, according to Forbes

~$200M
What Stuart Sternberg paid for the team

The purchase price was not disclosed; $1.7 billion is the reported figure.

TIMELINE

TWO OWNERS, ONE STADIUM SEARCH

OCT 2005
Stuart Sternberg takes over the Rays

SEP 30, 2025
Zalupski-led group closes its purchase of the Rays

AUG 28, 2026
Hillsborough County commissioners approve the deal 5-2

APR 2029
Anticipated ballpark opening

“

Today's vote marks a monumental step toward securing a forever home for the Tampa Bay Rays, while integrating a new Hillsborough College campus into an $8 billion private sector investment.

KEN HAGAN

Chair, Hillsborough County Board of County Commissioners

OCT 25, 2026

STILL OPEN

WHAT IS LEFT BEFORE THE FIRST PITCH

1 GROUNDBREAKING

Team officials said it needed to begin by September to open by Opening Day 2029. It has yet to begin.

2 MORE AGREEMENTS

As of Aug. 28, a Ballpark License & Use Agreement, a Community Benefits Agreement and a Construction Funds Trust Agreement were pending.

3 THE LEASE

Babby said the lease on the new park will last for 35 years, keeping the Rays in town until at least 2064.

SOURCES

SOURCES

USA Today Network via Yahoo Sports: As Trop preps for World Series, what's going on with Rays new stadium?
sports.yahoo.com

Hillsborough County: BOCC approves development and funding agreement
hcfl.gov

MLB.com: Rays sale finalized to ownership group led by Patrick Zalupski
mlb.com

MLB.com: Rays' new ballpark approved in county vote
mlb.com

WUSF: Tampa Bay Rays sale to Zalupski group approved by MLB owners
wusf.org

CBS Sports: MLB owners approve Patrick Zalupski deal
cbssports.com

Las Vegas Review-Journal: A's have spent $300M on Las Vegas ballpark project
reviewjournal.com

WSOC TV: Bank of America Stadium secures insurers for $1.3 billion overhaul
wsoctv.com

FULL STORY LINK IN THE FIRST COMMENT.